

August 12, 2026

Cigna Healthcare
Cigna Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 188011
Chattanooga, TN 37422

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Robby Jacobi (MRN MUSC3132294), Claim MUSC-20260516-AB04-1

Patient	Robby Jacobi (DOB 1913-01-13)
MRN	MUSC3132294
Member ID / Group	CIG261868966 / GRP-24386
Claim number	MUSC-20260516-AB04-1
Date of service	2026-05-16
Procedure billed	CPT 93458 — Left heart catheterization with coronary angiography
Primary diagnosis	I25.10 — Atherosclerotic heart disease of native coronary artery
Denied amount	\$11,923.84
Denial code	CARC 27 / RARC N30 — Expenses incurred after coverage terminated.
Appeal deadline	2026-12-13

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Robby Jacobi (MRN: MUSC3132294, Member ID: CIG261868966, Group: GRP-24386) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260516-AB04-1 for services rendered on May 16, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was denied under CARC 27 ("Expenses incurred after coverage terminated") and RARC N30 ("Patient ineligible for this service"), with the payer remark stating: "Member was not eligible for benefits on the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination. The member's Cigna Healthcare Choice Plus plan reflects a coverage period of January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026, which unambiguously encompasses the May 16, 2026, date of service. Accordingly, the eligibility-based denial is not supported by the coverage data on file and should be reversed.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Jacobi is a male patient with a well-documented, longstanding history of atherosclerotic heart disease of the native coronary artery (ICD-10 I25.10), which has been an active condition in his medical record. He carries additional active diagnoses including type 2 diabetes mellitus with microalbuminuria (ICD-10 E11.9), chronic kidney disease (ICD-10 N18.9), metabolic syndrome (ICD-10 R69), and hypertriglyceridemia — a constellation of comorbidities that substantially elevates his cardiovascular risk profile. His medication regimen includes active prescriptions for insulin and hydrochlorothiazide, consistent with ongoing management of these conditions. On May 16, 2026, Dr. Sarah E. Whitmore, MD (NPI 1447382910) performed a left heart catheterization with coronary angiography (CPT 93458) in the outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22) at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. This procedure is a recognized and appropriate diagnostic intervention for a patient presenting with active coronary artery disease and the comorbid burden documented in this record.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is that the member was not eligible for benefits on the date of service. This determination is factually inconsistent with the coverage information associated with this claim. The Cigna Healthcare Choice Plus plan on file for Member ID CIG261868966 under Group GRP-24386 carries an effective coverage period of January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026. The date of service, May 16, 2026, falls squarely within that active coverage window. No lapse, termination, or suspension of coverage has been communicated to MUSC Health, nor does any such event appear in the eligibility information available to this facility at the time of service or at the time of billing.

MUSC Health submitted the claim on June 4, 2026, within the applicable timely filing window, and the denial was issued on June 16, 2026. We respectfully assert that the payer bears the obligation to provide specific, documented evidence of any coverage termination that would support a CARC 27 denial. In the absence of such evidence, denial on eligibility grounds is improper. Payers are generally required under applicable insurance regulations and contractual obligations to process clean claims for covered members and to substantiate eligibility-based denials with verifiable termination data.

We request that Cigna conduct a thorough review of the eligibility records for this member as of May 16, 2026, and reconcile those records against the coverage period reflected in the plan documentation. Should Cigna identify a discrepancy in its own eligibility system, we ask that it be corrected and the claim reprocessed accordingly. The billed amount is \$11,923.84, with a contractual allowed amount of \$8,336.19; the current paid amount is \$0.00.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-20260516-AB04-1, confirm member eligibility as active on May 16, 2026, and reprocess the claim for payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$8,336.19. Supporting documentation, including the medical record for the May 16, 2026, encounter and eligibility verification records obtained at the time of service, is enclosed with this appeal submission per Cigna's appeal instructions. If additional information is required to complete this review, please contact the MUSC Health Revenue Cycle Appeals team promptly so that any outstanding items may be provided within the appeal deadline of December 13, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record